

Google Docs gets revamped

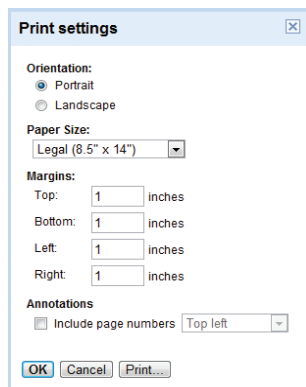
Google Docs is perhaps one of the most popular online productivity suites thanks to its good integration with Google services. Who hasn't noticed that "Open as a Google Document" link when receiving .doc or .xls files in Gmail? How long can you ignore it?

Google Docs has been getting a string of updates over the last few months, from simple tweaks in the interface layout

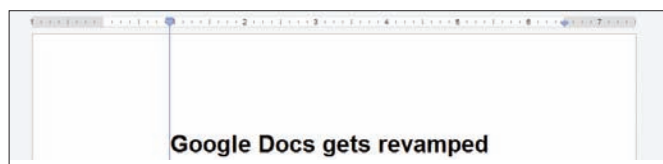
while enhancing support for formatting, and improving document import fidelity.

Google Docs Documents

If you use Google Docs coming from the Microsoft Office world, you are sure to find it woefully underpowered, it surely feels like taking a step backwards. The latest update closes in on the gap – which is still miles wide and a few miles deep – by



Altering print settings is now easier in Google Docs



The revamped ruler in Google Docs

to moving from a document editing application to a cloud storage provider.

Their latest update completely revamps all their online document editing tools, and adds a new applications to the Google Docs package, a drawing editor. With the latest update, Google Docs gains much more powerful collaboration features,

adding better formatting and layout tools.

Laying out content in Google Docs used to be an especially difficult task, and often required dabbling into the HTML code editor, and if you didn't know HTML or CSS, you were out of luck. With the new tools added to Docs laying out content is now incredibly easy.

First and foremost what you notice is a new ruler tool at the top of the document. This now lets you modify the margins of your content on a paragraph or document level. You can easily select a portion of text and drag the margins to better lay out your text.

Of course margins are useless unless you are working with a fixed document size! And this is another new addition to the document editor. A revamped "Print Settings" dialog will let you select a page size (Letter, A4...) from list of very few – but popular – selections. Here you

are also set orientation, margins and even have auto-numbering of pages.

Other new formatting options include line and paragraph spacing, more list styles and a much easier to use table editor. Inserted images can now be more freely placed on the page with text flowing around it..

Spelling check is now also better integrated into the editor and spelling suggestions appear in the right click menu for incorrectly spelled words.

Best of all of course are the new collaboration features which take collaborative creation and editing of documents to a whole new level. Google Docs now offers the kind of collaborative editing features available in Google Wave.

For those who don't know about the collaborative features Wave – I'll bet there will be few – here is a brief introduction. With wave one can start a conversation which people can reply to in real-time, or create a document which people can edit in real time. As you edit, each change you make is transmitted to the other person's computer in real time! You can thus see the changes others are making to your document,

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